

Dear Admissions Committee,

RE: RECOMMENDATION FOR EDITH NGUNDI.

I first met 'Iddi' at the San Francisco International Airport as I was trying to get a taxi to the school's residence hall. Edith was also in a similar situation though she seemed to have everything under control. She offered to order a taxi for both of us and reassured me that we'll be fine. Her composure made it hard to believe that also she had never been to America before. It was there that I made my first college friend, completely unaware of how instrumental she would be in my life. We shared the same bunk, took classes together, explored San Francisco, supported each other, and basically enjoyed the ups and downs of our college freshman year.

I'm honored to be writing this letter and painting the otherwise unseen side of my good friend to you. It would only be fair considering I was the one who had to endure how she spoke on and on about your prestigious college, sharing in the excitement as though we won a lottery.

I know Iddi has probably shown you her serious and committed side in other ways but I assure you that she is the funniest person ever! If I was to show you our conversations, 90% would be the laughing emoji and 10% moments of dry and crazy jokes. She just has this natural ability to make the atmosphere brim with happiness making her a joy to be around. Iddi has an outgoing and relatable personality that draws people to her and she easily becomes a favorite to her peers- kind of like a celebrity but without the drama. In social gatherings, Iddi always seemed to naturally fit into any group. She takes a keen interest in learning from people and so she is always down to having conversations with new faces. When there was that new kid that was too shy to talk to anyone, Iddi was there to make them feel like they belonged. You can't seem to hold her down, adding to the fact that she is always talking and making stories. Yeah! That's my bestie.

Iddi has to be the most determined and explorative girl I've ever met. She almost never gives up on anything that we undertake. She loves trying out new things and she is one of those people who have so many hobbies that you wonder if they have 48 hours instead of 24 in a day. One of the perks of being her friend is that you get to tag along with her on her adventures, whether absurd or downright exhausting. A memory that comes to mind is when she convinced me to walk to a school event, in an attempt to save the fare we would have used taking a bus. We barely knew how to get around San Francisco but that did not stop Edith and her thirst for adventure. Instead of following the path on our Google Maps, we took the shortest distance, what Iddi described as 'the hypotenuse of Market Street and Van Ness Avenue'. There we were testing our wits as we cut across streets, hoping we don't find ourselves lost, or worse, lost and hungry. The thrill and satisfaction of successfully accomplishing her experiments are what always pushes her to keep on trying and learning from them. The first time she wore roller skates, she insisted on riding them even after falling and bruising herself a couple of times. She would laugh, get up and try over and over again. As her friend, I find that remarkable!

Edith has always been big on social impact, devoting a fair amount of her time to community service. It broke her heart every time we got into the streets and saw hundreds of homeless people lying by the sidewalk, hungry and cold. She was so concerned about their welfare that she took advantage of whichever resources and organizations she could to assist them. Every Tuesday, Thursday, and Friday afternoon, she would literally sprint to St Anthony's Foundation for a 5-hour volunteering shift. She adored serving the guests in the dining hall, where she cleaned the tables and ushered the guests to their chairs. Sometimes she volunteered in the clothing section and assisted the guests in the fitting rooms. She would come back to our room exhausted but content with the work she had done and the connections she made. Iddi loved telling me about the homeless people she met, speaking with so much wonder and hope. There were so many lessons to unpack from her stories but one stuck with me. Iddi would always say: "Do good and do it well." I believe the folks at St. Anthony's truly miss her cheerful devotion and service.

Edith's charisma, energy, and wholesomeness is truly a blessing to all. I'm convinced that Iddi will bring a positive impact and contribute meaningfully and unforgettably to your school community as she does in my life. If Iddi comes to your school, please remind her that she owes me a trip to Hollywood. I will truly miss having her around at Minerva.

Yours,

Gal Rubin

Sophomore at Minerva Schools at KGI